

KYLE GAARDER

Senior Product Manager | Consumer Experience | Retention

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SUMMARY

Experience designer who builds complete customer journeys from scratch. Designed the entire resident experience at a coliving property - onboarding, engagement, and retention - achieving 94% occupancy for 19 months. I obsess over experience, test constantly, and measure success by whether people come back.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching
- 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Designed complete customer experience from scratch - onboarding, engagement, conflict resolution
 - Built retention engine sustaining 94% occupancy for 19 months through experience iteration
 - Ran 48 community dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 programs, synthesizing feedback into improvements
 - Executed A/B testing on pricing and stay-length models, driving 48% revenue lift at 94% occupancy

- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY
- through experience-driven optimization
- Built insights engine via member interviews and events, turning
- patterns into product decisions

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots
- outreach and validation
 - Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand user needs and journey pain points
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
 - Led consumer experience development across strategy, ops, and product in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎 **Complete CX from Scratch**
- Designed end-to-end customer experience - onboarding, engagement, retention, and resolution
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- 💎 **94% Retention via Experience**
- Experience-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
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- 💎 **48% Revenue via Experiments**
- A/B tested pricing and engagement programs driving 48% annual revenue growth
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- 💎 **Investor Pilot Secured**
- Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
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- 💎 **Demand Pipeline Built**
- Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- Consumer Experience Design**
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- Retention & Engagement**
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- User Research & Synthesis**
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- A/B Testing & Experiments**
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- Journey Mapping Onboarding**
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- Stakeholder Management Analytics**
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- Partnerships Market Creation**
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EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology**
- Virginia Tech**
- 📅 08/2010 - 05/2014
- 📍 Virginia, USA
- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish
- GPA **3.5 / 4.0**